

Generated from the competition table

# 1981 Men's Ballon d'Or

Everything the Men's Ballon d'Or table records about 1981, with the winner linked to their full award history and their national team linked to its own record.

Winner

**Karl-Heinz Rummenigge**

National team

**West Germany**

Ceremony date

**29 December 1981**

**All Men's Ballon d'Or editions →**



## References & review

**Status: verified**

Last reviewed: 14 August 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>)
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/europa-poy65.html>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.britannica.com/topic/Ballon-dOr>)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.jeuneafrique.com/381505/politique/jour-26-dece-mbre-1995-george-weah-elu-ballon-dor/>)
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.voanews.com/>).
- Ceremony date second independent cross-check (2026-08-13, intensive run) (<https://www.uefa.com/uefachampionsleague/news/>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.